

Australia Student Visa Guide

Visa Type

The Student Visa (Subclass 500) allows international students to stay in Australia to study full-time at a recognized Australian education institution. It covers school, vocational, higher education, and postgraduate research programs.

Required Documents

- Valid passport, valid for at least 6 months beyond the intended stay
- Confirmation of Enrolment (CoE) from a registered Australian institution
- Genuine Temporary Entrant (GTE) statement explaining study intentions and ties to home country
- English language proficiency proof, such as IELTS 5.5 or higher, TOEFL, or PTE
- Evidence of financial capacity to cover tuition and living costs
- Overseas Student Health Cover (OSHC) for the full duration of the course
- Academic transcripts and certificates
- Statement of Purpose (SOP)
- Police clearance certificate, if required
- Health examination results, if required

Financial Requirements

Applicants must show evidence of funds covering tuition fees plus living costs of approximately 21,041 AUD per year for the student. An additional 7,362 AUD per year is required for an accompanying partner, and 3,152 AUD per year for each accompanying child. Funds are usually demonstrated through bank statements covering the last 3 to 6 months, or through a scholarship or sponsor letter.

Processing Time

Most Subclass 500 applications are processed within 4 to 6 weeks, though times can range from 2 weeks to 3 months depending on individual circumstances. According to recent published data, 75 percent of applications are finalized within 29 days and 90 percent within 40 days.

Application Steps

- Receive a Confirmation of Enrolment (CoE) from your Australian institution after accepting an offer
- Gather all required supporting documents
- Create an ImmiAccount on the Department of Home Affairs website
- Complete the online application form, Form 157A
- Pay the visa application fee, currently 710 AUD as a base charge
- Provide biometrics if requested

- Complete a health examination if requested
- Wait for a decision; you may be contacted for additional information or documents
- Receive your visa grant notification by email

Interview Requirements

There is no formal interview required for the Subclass 500 visa. Instead, applicants must satisfy the Genuine Temporary Entrant requirement through a written statement addressing their study intentions, financial circumstances, and ties to their home country.

Work Rights

Student visa holders may work up to 48 hours per fortnight while their course is in session, and unlimited hours during scheduled course breaks.

Common FAQs

- Can I bring family members? Yes, eligible family members such as a spouse or partner and dependent children can be included on a Subclass 500 application.
- Do I need OSHC for the entire stay? Yes, Overseas Student Health Cover is mandatory for the full duration of the student visa and must be arranged before the visa is granted.
- What is the GTE requirement? The Genuine Temporary Entrant requirement assesses whether an applicant genuinely intends a temporary stay in Australia for study purposes, based on personal circumstances, immigration history, and the value of the course to the applicant's future.